RESEARCH

Why the published gender pay gap flatters

Client: Any HR or reward team about to benchmark its first pay gap report against the national figure Eurostat publishes.

> **Is the national gap the right benchmark, and where will pay transparency bite hardest?**

12.2% → 14.6%
EU gap, published against within sectors, 2022

22 of 27
Member States where the gap inside sectors is wider

3.8% → 14.4%
Italy, published against within sectors

51%
of employees in enterprises that report every year

WHAT I DID

- Decomposed the published 2022 gap of each of the 27 Member States into a between-sector and a within-sector part, reconciled with Eurostat's own figures.
- Set each country's within-sector gap against its exposure to annual reporting: the share of employees in enterprises of 250 or more.
- Published an article, a working paper and an explorer for every country, all rebuilt from data snapshots in R and Quarto.

WHAT IT FOUND

- Women are over-represented in sectors that pay above average, such as education and health, which lowers the national figure: the lowest headlines hide the most.
- In all six countries with complete data by enterprise size, the gap is wider in the enterprises of 250 or more, the first to report.

WITH REAL DATA

- A client's own report set against its sector's within-sector gap, not the national one.
- The 2026 Structure of Earnings Survey when Eurostat releases it.

How it is checked. Decomposition identities and the reconciliation with Eurostat's published gaps tested in R (64 tests); every table rebuilt from pinned snapshots.

Eurostat SES · Decomposition · R and Quarto · Research writing · Data visualisation

Read the article https://d0m3n1c0x.github.io/where-pay-transparency-bites/

Open the explorer https://d0m3n1c0x.github.io/where-pay-transparency-bites/dashboard/

The repository https://github.com/D0M3N1C0X/where-pay-transparency-bites